

# Japan With Kids

Family Trip Checklist & Planner · a free guide from littletabi.com · 2026

Everything we wish we'd known before travelling around Japan with young kids - a print-friendly checklist, the facts that actually matter in 2026, and a gentle 7-day Tokyo plan. Tick the boxes as you pack.

## Documents & money

- ☐ Passports valid 6+ months; check if your nationality needs a visa
- ☐ Travel / health insurance that covers your children
- ☐ Print or screenshot hotel bookings, flights and pre-booked tickets
- ☐ A tap-card plan: Suica, PASMO or ICOCA (or Welcome Suica for visitors)
- ☐ Some yen cash for day one (small shops & shrines are often cash-only)
- ☐ A photo of each child + your hotel address, in case you get separated

## Health & safety

- ☐ Regular medicines in original packaging + a small first-aid kit
- ☐ Save the emergency numbers: 119 (ambulance / fire), 110 (police)
- ☐ Your child's usual fever / pain medicine - brands differ in Japan
- ☐ For allergies: a translated allergy card to show at restaurants
- ☐ Note the nearest clinic & pharmacy to your hotel
- ☐ A hat, sunscreen and hand sanitiser in your day bag

## Packing for kids

- ☐ A day or two of diapers / formula, then buy locally - it's everywhere
- ☐ Refillable water bottles and a change of clothes in the day bag
- ☐ A lightweight, foldable stroller or a carrier for crowded stations
- ☐ Season-right layers (summers hot & humid; winters cold but mild)
- ☐ Plane snacks and something for the 'are we there yet' moments
- ☐ A familiar comfort toy for naps and long train rides

## Getting around & luggage

- ☐ Big suitcases on the Shinkansen: bags 160-250 cm (length+width+height) need a free advance 'oversized baggage' seat reservation
- ☐ Consider luggage forwarding (takuhaibin) hotel-to-hotel, or day luggage storage - station coin lockers fill up fast, especially large ones
- ☐ Kids' train fares: children aged 6-11 pay about half; under 6 usually ride free (see the fact box overleaf)

## Tech & connectivity

- ☐ Sort an eSIM or pocket Wi-Fi before you land (maps + translation)
- ☐ Power bank for long park days
- ☐ Download offline maps and a translation language pack
- ☐ The right plug: Japan is Type A, 100 V

## Good-to-know facts for 2026

We keep these on one page because they change and they trip families up. Checked against official sources on 2026-07-07 - always confirm before you go.

### Disney rental strollers

At Tokyo Disneyland & DisneySea, rental strollers are for children who can sit unassisted (about 7 months+), up to 100 cm tall and up to 15 kg.

Bring your own if your child is bigger. Confirm on the official Tokyo Disney Resort site.

### Kids' train fares (JR)

Children aged 6–11 pay half the adult fare (Green / sleeper tickets are full price). Under 6 ride free - up to two under-6s per paying adult in non-reserved seats.

Source: JR-Central. Confirm on the official site.

### Shinkansen with big suitcases

On the Tokaido / Sanyo / Kyushu Shinkansen, baggage of 160–250 cm total (L+W+H) needs a free 'oversized baggage' seat reservation. Over 250 cm isn't allowed.

Reserve when you book your seat. Confirm on the official site.

### Tax-free shopping

Spend at least 5,000 yen (pre-tax) at one store on the same day. From 1 Nov 2026, Japan moves to a refund method: pay the tax-included price and claim the refund at the airport.

Bring your passport. Confirm current rules on official sources.

## A gentle 7-day Tokyo plan (with young kids)

One big thing a day, buffers for naps and meltdowns, and plenty of snack breaks. Pre-book anything with timed entry.

### Day 1 - Arrive & settle

Land, pick up IC cards, check in, then a gentle neighbourhood stroll and a konbini (convenience-store) dinner. Kid tip: early night to beat jet lag - don't overplan day one.

### Day 2 - Asakusa & the river

Senso-ji temple and snacks along Nakamise, then an easy Sumida River boat (stroller-friendly and very visual). Rainy day: Sumida Aquarium at Tokyo Skytree.

### Day 3 - Ueno

Ueno Zoo and the wide park to run around; pick just one museum (the Nature & Science museum is a hit). Leave a buffer for naps.

### Day 4 - teamLab & the bay

Book teamLab Planets tickets ahead. Afternoon around Odaiba / Miraikan. Keep it light after a big morning.

### Day 5 - Tokyo Disneyland or DisneySea

One park, one day. Rent a stroller at the gate (up to 100 cm / 15 kg). Plan around a midday rest; pre-book any paid ride reservations in the official app.

### Day 6 - Shibuya / Harajuku slow day

The Scramble Crossing, a themed cafe, gacha machines and Yoyogi Park. Short hops and lots of snack breaks.

### Day 7 - Flex & fly

A buffer morning, last-minute (tax-free) shopping, luggage forwarding or storage, and off to the airport early.

Going beyond Tokyo? Our full 10-day Tokyo-Kyoto-Osaka family itinerary is free on the site.

## Handy references

In an emergency Dial 119 for ambulance / fire and 110 for police - free from any phone, and you can ask for an English-speaking operator. Japan also has a free 24-hour visitor hotline run by JNTO (search 'JNTO Japan Visitor Hotline').

## A few useful phrases

| English                         | Say it (romaji)                           | 日本語               |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Does this contain [X]?          | Kore ni [X] wa haitte imasu ka?           | これに〇〇は入っていますか？    |
| My child has a food allergy.    | Kodomo ni shokumotsu-arerugii ga arimasu. | 子どもに食物アレルギーがあります。 |
| Where is the nearest toilet?    | Ichiban chikai toire wa doko desu ka?     | 一番近いトイレはどこですか？    |
| Is there a nursing / baby room? | Jugyuushitsu wa arimasu ka?               | 授乳室はありますか？        |
| Help, please!                   | Tasukete kudasai!                         | 助けてください！          |
| Thank you!                      | Arigatou gozaimasu!                       | ありがとうございます！       |

## Free guides to explore next

|                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| → Make a printable allergy card      | <a href="https://littletabi.com/tools/allergy-card.html">littletabi.com/tools/allergy-card.html</a>                                                                                     |
| → Full family packing list           | <a href="https://littletabi.com/essential-packing-list-for-japan-with-kids-2026.html">littletabi.com/essential-packing-list-for-japan-with-kids-2026.html</a>                           |
| → 10-day Tokyo-Kyoto-Osaka itinerary | <a href="https://littletabi.com/japan-family-itinerary-tokyo-kyoto-osaka-with-young-children.html">littletabi.com/japan-family-itinerary-tokyo-kyoto-osaka-with-young-children.html</a> |
| → Best family hotels in Tokyo        | <a href="https://littletabi.com/best-family-hotels-tokyo-connecting-rooms.html">littletabi.com/best-family-hotels-tokyo-connecting-rooms.html</a>                                       |
| → Family eSIMs compared              | <a href="https://littletabi.com/japan-esim-for-families-compared.html">littletabi.com/japan-esim-for-families-compared.html</a>                                                         |
| → Build a free trip plan             | <a href="https://littletabi.com/plan.html">littletabi.com/plan.html</a>                                                                                                                 |

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